

Tonal training

Types of tone:

- Confused
- Curious
- Concerned
- Challenging/skeptical
- Playful

A big part of sales is conveying emotions. This is what our tone helps us do.

It's also true that when we're anxious or afraid before a call, it will show in our tone for the same reason.

So mastering your state of mind and your emotions is mastering your tone.

Why...

Confused

- Why sound confused? Because people want to help people who are confused. You draw them to you. They open up.
- For example, you can respond in an empathetic way and tilt your head: "Tough, huh?"

Curious

- Why? They need to understand that I'm here to help them and not to push anything on them.

Concerned

- Because I genuinely know that if they don't change something, they'll stay in the same situation

- The concern in your voice helps amplify their sense of pain—which is genuine
- For example... “*But... what happens if nothing changes then ??*”

Challenging

- Because I don’t want them to buy into their own limitations. I know they can do more, and it’s better for them.

Playful

- Because helping people is fun and not a stressful process
- It allows them to open up to you
- Important to use a lot at the beginning when they have to be completely honest, and they aren’t completely honest when under stress or anxiety

How do I know what tone to use?

- Always ask yourself, “What do I want them to feel?”
- Use the tone that promotes what they need to feel

Perception, Intent, and Value

For them to take in all the information you’re saying and actually understand why they should—or must—buy, you need to follow three steps

1. Their perception of you

First, they must form the right perception of you; otherwise, they will never allow themselves to absorb and trust what you say. You do this through tone—that is, by conveying the right energy and emotions to them.

Emotions that show you understand, listen, want to help, and are trustworthy.

2. Your intention

The way what you say comes across to them. This is also important to master. Otherwise, misunderstandings can occur, or you might just come across as too salesy. This is also partly achieved through tone.

3. The value you offer

What we actually provide them with.

Different aspects and how you should come across in them...

At the beginning

- Here, you need zero sales resistance. Nothing should suggest that you're trying to sell them something.
- That's why you need to sound curious, so they can open up when they realize you want to listen and not just sell
- But also playful, so you come across as a normal, friendly person and not a creep. They'll open up more that way.
- We can never be sure why they're in the situation they're in
- How: Tilt your head, ask lots of questions in a curious tone
- To practice this, you can film yourself and practice

When we get to the problem

- A mix of curiosity and concern
- When someone explains their problem to us, we feel concerned, because that feeling is conveyed to the prospect. When they feel concerned, the problem becomes more serious and creates a greater sense of urgency to solve it.
- If you don't help them alleviate the pain, people tend not to change their minds
- Not: "Tell me more..." nonchalantly
- But: "What...!?" with a leaning-in, close, concerned expression and a different tone
- We can also use our language to ensure our intent comes across correctly...
"I mean... that's a little concerning, can you tell me more about it?"

- React as if your best friend suddenly told you out of the blue that he has an illness. Don't just overdo it.

Understand the buying decision

- Here, we shift—usually quite quickly—our tone to become challenging and skeptical.
- In a way, we're pushing the customer away. So they understand that we're here to help them, but ONLY IF they actually want to. This highlights the fact that they're the ones who have to change their situation. And there's no pressure on my part to close the sale.
- Everyone has some belief that isn't based on anything logical. Sometimes you have to be direct and real with them so they understand that these beliefs aren't worth holding onto. That's where skepticism comes in.
- "Here's the thing... do you really want to solve the problem?" + direct tone and dismissive body language
- "May I challenge what you just said a little?"

Future pacing - When we paint a picture of the results

- A lighter, more interested, and curious tone.
- They're describing their ideal future to us; we need to reward that by showing interest in what they're saying. The best way is to ask questions about the details they're talking about.
- Talk as if you're interested in something someone is excited about. Something new, a dream trip, a win...
- If you can visualize something, the chance that you'll actually pursue that reality is greater. We help them visualize.

Addressing the consequences

- Concerned, a bit challenging
- So that we can amplify the sense of urgency behind the need for change
- Their perception of you is that you actually care

Building the "gap"

- In a sales conversation, you need to create a bridge. The bridge, divided into their current stage and desired outcomes, is one of the biggest drivers behind their decision to buy.
- People want *to escape* their current situation → We get there by asking "*What?*" → We ensure the answers we provide are credible through how we present ourselves—that is, by using the right tone
- People *strive toward* their dreams and desired outcomes → We uncover this by asking *Why?* → We ensure our answers are credible by using the right tone when we ask

Commitment

- A strongly challenging tone
- We want them to *justify why they need* to change
- Here you must be direct and honest with them, and ask the tough questions—the ones they don't always dare to ask themselves

Probing & Clarifying

- Confused or curious, depending on the context
- Confused → 'Ah, he doesn't know what I'm talking about, let me clarify'
- "What do you mean by that?" + lean in, change your tone

Verbal pace

- How fast vs. slow we say something adds to what we're saying
- When you want to draw more attention to a
- TIMING is also very important
- You need to maintain a medium pace throughout the call to be able to emphasize. If you overdo any tone or pace, it becomes irrelevant